

The Pros and Cons: Laptops and Tablets

LAPTOPS:

Pros

- Laptops come with physical keyboards, which are more productive
- Laptops have larger screens.
- More ports and I/O options; USB, HDMI, Ethernet, Audio and much more (psst dongles).
- Better cooling.
- Better resale value.

Cons

- Good/powerful laptops are expensive
- Hardware gets dated sooner
- Less handy than tablets

TABLETS:

Pros

- Great UI and UX; the name of the game is user-friendliness.
- Very portable and lightweight

- Better camera.
- Support for SIM cards.

Cons

- Touch keypads aren't as fast or efficient as physical ones.
- You may need several external accessories to get your ideal setup.
- Overheating.
- Hardware may not be powerful enough to handle all your tasks.

tablets. As of right now, Android and iOS are the leading OS on tablets. The advantage of being in iOS here is that it's far more optimised. But the point that apps and softwares have features stripped for optimal optimisation and performance still stands. Certain apps will also be limited on tablets because of a lack of input methods.

Portability

Tablets are the more portable of the two. That is a given. Tablet sizes obviously vary, but the largest and heaviest of them will still weigh less than the lightest laptop, at least for now. We've already seen some incredibly lightweight laptops in recent times, the LG Gram (which weighs under a kilo) comes to mind. Still, this is still a point that is currently in the tablet's favour.

Storage

Most tablets come with storage ranging from 16 GB to 128 GB, however, again, premium tablets can offer much much higher capacities, even as high as 2 TB. This of course, costs a premium, even more than the cost of some laptops. 512 GB is almost the norm now on laptops, and it's easy to use external storage devices like USB sticks, SSDs and even microSD cards to further boost a laptop's storage capabilities.

Battery Life

Overall, you will find that tablets last a lot longer than laptops. Of course, there are some exceptions. The number of power hungry components in a laptop is much more, and as such even with higher capacity batteries, most tablets will outlast laptops.

Gaming

While tablets have access to a lot of games, and even popular titles like Fortnite, PUBG, CoD and Genshin Impact, there's no denying that the hardware will eventually become a bottleneck. Including the weaker cooling capabilities. Laptops and the OS they come with will allow you to play more modern AAA games (providing you have the GPU to support it) which require a lot more juice to run. Forget tablets, even cheaper laptops can struggle with these.

Price

Finally, we come to the price. In general, you will find that tablets are far cheaper than laptops. If you're looking for a basic device to complete basic work operations, then a tablet will more than suffice without breaking the bank. Of course, premium tablets can be as pricey as good laptops, but they come with the perks associated with them as well. Laptops on the hand, while not starting as cheap as tablets have become incredibly cheap for the most basic models. Of course, this can ramp up to absurdly expensive prices for the highest-end laptops, but the entry bar is very low.

What to go for?

Unless you're keen on the ultra-portability of a tablet, a laptop is still the better option. The benefits and convenience of the average laptop are far too great at the moment to warrant making the switch entirely to tablet. Tablets still have quite a few restrictions in terms of their technical capabilities, despite being the more portable and battery efficient device. **d**